

[BUG] QNGOptimizer with molecular_hamiltonian

<https://github.com/PennyLaneAI/pennylane/issues/2502>

ROW 81

[BUG] QNGOptimizer with molecular_hamiltonian #2502

New issue

Closed



KetpuntoG opened on Apr 27, 2022

Expected behavior

The following code was to be executed:

```
import pennylane as qml
from pennylane import qchem
from pennylane import numpy as np
import time

symbols = ["Li", "H"]
geometry = np.array([0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 2.969280527])

H, qubits = qchem.molecular_hamiltonian(
    symbols,
    geometry,
    active_electrons=2,
    active_orbitals=5
)

dev = qml.device("default.qubit", wires = 10)

@qml.qnode(dev)
def circuit(param):
    qml.DoubleExcitation(param[0], wires=[0,1,2,3])
    return qml.expval(H)

opt = qml.QNGOptimizer(stepsize=0.5)

param = np.array([1.], requires_grad = True)
param = opt.step(circuit, param)
print(param)
```

Actual behavior

the code does not work because this error is displayed:

```
DiagGatesUndefinedError
```

Additional information

The above error is due to the fact that for some reason the DoubleExcitation operator is not expanded in the process. Decomposing manually solves the problem.

```
import pennylane as qml
from pennylane import qchem
from pennylane import numpy as np
import time

symbols = ["Li", "H"]
geometry = np.array([0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 2.969280527])

H, qubits = qchem.molecular_hamiltonian(
    symbols,
    geometry,
    active_electrons=2,
    active_orbitals=5
)

dev = qml.device("default.qubit", wires = 10)
```

Assignees

KetpuntoG

Labels

bug

Type

No type

Projects

No projects

Milestone

No milestone

Relationships

None yet

Development

No branches or pull requests

Notifications

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Participants



```
@qml.qnode(dev)
def circuit(param):
    with qml.tape.stop_recording():
        ops = qml.DoubleExcitation(param[0], wires=[0,1,2,3]).decomposition()
        for op in ops:
            qml.apply(op)
        return qml.expval(H)

opt = qml.QNGOptimizer(stepsize=0.5)

param = np.array([1.], requires_grad = True)
param = opt.step(circuit, param)
print(param)
```

However, a new error appears:

```
Operation Hamiltonian is not written in terms of a single parameter
```

This error is due to casting when obtaining the qchem Hamiltonian. It can be solved manually by adding the following line after defining the Hamiltonian:

```
H = qml.Hamiltonian([float(co) for co in H.coeffs], H.ops)
```

But this is something that should be fixed internally and not have to be done manually.

Source code

No response

Tracebacks

No response

System information

```
Name: PennyLane
Version: 0.24.0.dev0
Summary: PennyLane is a Python quantum machine learning library by Xanadu Inc.
Home-page: https://github.com/XanaduAI/pennylane
Author: None
Author-email: None
License: Apache License 2.0
Location: /Users/guille/Documents/GitHub/pennylane
Requires: numpy, scipy, networkx, retworkx, autograd, toml, appdirs, semantic-version, autoray, cachetools, psutil
Required-by: PennyLane-Qchem, PennyLane-Lightning, PennyLane-SF, PennyLane-qiskit, my-research

Platform info:          macOS-10.16-x86_64-i386-64bit
Python version:         3.8.8
Numpy version:          1.20.2
Scipy version:          1.6.2
Installed devices:
- lightning.qubit (PennyLane-Lightning-0.22.1)
- strawberryfields.fock (PennyLane-SF-0.20.0.dev0)
- strawberryfields.gaussian (PennyLane-SF-0.20.0.dev0)
- strawberryfields.gbs (PennyLane-SF-0.20.0.dev0)
- strawberryfields.remote (PennyLane-SF-0.20.0.dev0)
- strawberryfields.tf (PennyLane-SF-0.20.0.dev0)
- qiskit.aer (PennyLane-qiskit-0.19.0.dev0)
- qiskit.basicaer (PennyLane-qiskit-0.19.0.dev0)
- qiskit.ibmq (PennyLane-qiskit-0.19.0.dev0)
- qiskit.ibmq.circuitrunner (PennyLane-qiskit-0.19.0.dev0)
- qiskit.ibmq.sampler (PennyLane-qiskit-0.19.0.dev0)
- default.gaussian (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.mixed (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.qubit (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.qubit.autograd (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.qubit.jax (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.qubit.tf (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
- default.qubit.torch (PennyLane-0.24.0.dev0)
```

Existing GitHub issues

Existing GitHub issues

- ☒ I have searched existing GitHub issues to make sure the issue does not already exist.



KetpuntoG added **bug** 🐛 on Apr 27, 2022



antalszava on Apr 27, 2022

Contributor ...

Thank you [@KetpuntoG](#) for the report! [@soranjh](#) any thoughts here?

However, a new error appears:
Operation Hamiltonian is not written in terms of a single parameter
This error is due to casting when obtaining the qchem Hamiltonian. It can be solved manually by adding the following line after defining the Hamiltonian:
`H = qml.Hamiltonian([float(co) for co in H.coefs], H.ops)`
But this is something that should be fixed internally and not have to be done manually.

Would this error be resolved even if `requires_grad=False` was set for the coefficients? We were discussing this with Soran and came to the conclusion, that `requires_grad=False` would have to be set by users explicitly because we would like them to have the mindset of using the differentiable HF solver.



antalszava on Apr 27, 2022

Contributor ...

Having said that, some more pointers or a dedicated error message could be added to help users here.



KetpuntoG on Apr 27, 2022

Contributor Author ...

I tried that:

```
geometry = np.array([0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 0.0, 2.969280527], requires_grad = False)
```



and the error is the same



soranjh on Apr 27, 2022

Contributor ...

The bug is not particular to Hamiltonians generated with the `molecular_hamiltonian` function.

1. `QNGOptimizer` fails even if the Hamiltonian is `H = qml.Hamiltonian([1.0], [qml.Identity(wires={0})])` when the circuit contains `qml.DoubleExcitation(param[0], wires=[0,1,2,3])`.
2. `QNGOptimizer` fails with any Hamiltonian that has differentiable coefficients, i.e., where `H.coefs` has `requires_grad=True`.

In the [Accelerating VQEs with quantum natural gradient](#) demo a solution is provided for the second issue:

We also need to make the Hamiltonian coefficients non-differentiable by setting `requires_grad=False`.
`hamiltonian = qml.Hamiltonian(np.array(hamiltonian.coefs, requires_grad=False), hamiltonian.ops)`

Another solution could be modifying the `QNGOptimizer` to handle differentiable Hamiltonians properly. As another solution, the Hamiltonian coefficients can be made non-differentiable by default, which is not the best option from the qchem perspective.



1

Go to

 KetpuntoG self-assigned this on Apr 28, 2022



KetpuntoG on Apr 28, 2022

Contributor Author ...

Okay, I'll try to make some time today to solve the problem. Thanks! 🙏



2



josh146 on Apr 28, 2022 · edited by josh146

Edits Member ...

@KetpuntoG I would turn this into two separate issues, since there are two separate bugs here! This way solving one of the bugs does not block closing an issue.

1. The first bug is that `qml.DoubleExcitation` returns a `Hamiltonian` when you call `DoubleExcitation.generator`. Since `Hamiltonian` does not have `diagonalizing_gates` defined, this line in the metric tensor causes an issue:

[pennylane/pennylane/transforms/metric_tensor.py](#)
Line 405 in b9bc9be

```
405 o.diagonalizing_gates()
```

Here is code to reproduce it:

```
@qml.qnode(dev)
def circuit(param):
    qml.DoubleExcitation(param[0], wires=[0,1,2,3])
    return qml.expval(qml.PauliZ(0))
```



I don't know the best solution here, but it might involve forcing the metric tensor transform to decompose any operation that returns Hamiltonians as generators.

2. The other bug is related to `expval(H)`, and can be seen with this example:

```
@qml.qnode(dev)
def circuit(param):
    qml.RX(param[0], wires=0)
    return qml.expval(H)
```



This is due to the `graph.iterate_parametrized_layers()` here:

```
pennylane/pennylane/transforms/metric\_tensor.py  
Lines 386 to 395 in b9bc9be
386 for queue, curr_ops, param_idx, _ in graph.iterate_parametrized_layers():
387     params_list.append(param_idx)
388     coeffs_list.append([])
389     obs_list.append([])
390
391     # for each operation in the layer, get the generator
392     for op in curr_ops:
393         obs, s = qml.generator(op)
394         obs_list[-1].append(obs)
395         coeffs_list[-1].append(s)
```

In particular, because the Hamiltonian coefficients are trainable, it is being counted as a parametrized layer! I think a good solution here is to *exclude* Hamiltonians for being considered either inside `iterate_parametrized_layers()`, or within this for loop:

```
pennylane/pennylane/transforms/metric\_tensor.py  
Line 392 in b9bc9be
392 for op in curr_ops:
```



 KetpuntoG mentioned this on Apr 29, 2022

[QNGOptimizer_Hamiltonian #2524](#)

```
392         for op in curr_ops:
393             obs, s = qml.generator(op)
394             obs_list[-1].append(obs)
395             coeffs_list[-1].append(s)
```

In particular, because the Hamiltonian coefficients are trainable, it is being counted as a parametrized layer! I think a good solution here is to *exclude* Hamiltonians for being considered either inside `iterate_parametrized_layers()`, or within this for loop:

[pennylane/pennylane/transforms/metric_tensor.py](#)
Line 392 in b9bc9be

```
392         for op in curr_ops:
```



KetpuntoG mentioned this on Apr 29, 2022

[QNGOptimizer_Hamiltonian #2524](#)



antalszava on May 3, 2022

Contributor ...

Hi @KetpuntoG just double-checking: did [#2524](#) only partially solve this issue?



KetpuntoG on May 3, 2022

Contributor Author ...

One issue is solved and the other is solved if you use:

```
hamiltonian = qml.Hamiltonian(np.array(hamiltonian.coeffs, requires_grad=False), hamiltonian.ops)
```



So it is not an error as such. It's just to keep in mind that the Hamiltonian has trainable parameters by default and we should set `requires_grad = False`.



antalszava on May 10, 2022

Contributor ...

Thanks, closing this.



antalszava closed this as completed on May 10, 2022

QNGOptimizer_Hamiltonian #2524

<> Code

Merged KetpuntoG merged 10 commits into `master` from `qng_hamiltonian` on Apr 29, 2022

Conversation 16 Commits 10 Checks 0 Files changed 5

+65 -3



KetpuntoG commented on Apr 29, 2022 · edited

Contributor

Context:

When using `QNGOptimizer` with `DoubleExcitation` an error occurred because the `DoubleExcitation` generator is a Hamiltonian and there is no diagonalization method.

Description of the Change:

A function has been added to check if the generator is a Hamiltonian with more than one term (since if it has only one term it can be treated as a simple operator). If it is a Hamiltonian, we expand the operation.

Benefits:

`QNGOptimizer` can now be used with more gates

Possible Drawbacks:

Perhaps in other cases it is better not to expand (?)

Related GitHub Issues:

[#2502](#)



QNGOptimizer_Hamiltonian

c4fd8eb



github-actions bot commented on Apr 29, 2022

Contributor

Hello. You may have forgotten to update the changelog!

Please edit [doc/releases/changelog-dev.md](#) with:

- A one-to-two sentence description of the change. You may include a small working example for new features.
- A link back to this PR.
- Your name (or GitHub username) in the contributors section.



Reviewers

antalszava ✓

josh146 ✓

Assignees

No one assigned

Labels

None yet

Projects

None yet

Milestone

No milestone

Development

Successfully merging this pull request may close these issues.

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